People belonging to the "middle income group" can surely have more variety by including more of cereals (rice\wheat), pulses, milk, fruits,and vegetables. They can have reasonable amounts of fats\oils and sugar in their diets. However, use of nuts\oilseeds and other miscellaneous foods like jam, jellies etc would be limited. As income rises one gets the freedom to choose from a wide variety of foods –or out of season, locally available or purchased from outside. Consumption of milk and milk products, meat, vegetables, fruits, fats,and oils tends to increase. But care needs to be taken that foods like fats, oils, sugars, are not taken in amounts more than needed by the body.

1.6.1 Dietary Guidelines to reduce the cost of a meal

1. The inclusion of millets like ragi, jowar, and bajra can reduce the cost of a meal.
2. Combination of cereals and pulses improve the quality of cereal as well as pulse protein.
3. Pulses like horse gram can be included to reduce the cost of a meal.
4. Fermenting, malting and sprouting can be done at home which enhances the nutritive value without increasing the processing cost.
5. Greens, particularly from trees like drumstick or agathi, are cheaper. Locally available or kitchen garden produce can be used.
6. Leaves of cauliflower, carrots, knolkhol and beet root which are highly nutritious can become part of a meal. Curry leaves can be used in consumable form like chutneys, chutney powder or in ground form in curry leaves pulao.
7. Inexpensive and nutritious fruits like papaya and guava can be included in the diet.
8. Inclusion of dry fish (like nethili) may supply a good amount of nutrients without increasing the cost.
9. Jaggery can be used instead of sugar.
10. Toned milk with low fat is less expensive but gives all other nutrients except fat.
11. Steamed foods are less expensive than fried foods. Low-cost diets have less amount of fats, oils,and sugars.
12. Natural foods are less expensive compared to processed and preserved foods.
13. Foods that are distributed through the public distribution system (Ration shops) can be used.
14. Recipes made at home are cheaper than bought. Homemade food can be carried to the workplace instead of buying from the canteen.
15. The inclusion of locally available ingredients and seasonal foods reduce the cost of a meal



Activity : 3

Mr. A. is an accountant in a government office in Chennai. His office timings are 9.00 a.m. to 5.30 p.m. His meal pattern is as follows. He has bed-tea early morning. Before leaving for his office he eats a heavy breakfast. He carries a packed lunch to office (which he eats around 1.30 p.m.). Before lunch, around mid-morning, he usually takes tea along with his friends. Around 4- 4.30 p.m. he has another cup of tea supplemented with a snack. He returns home around 7.30p.m.and has dinner right away. Then late at night, before going to bed he drinks a glass of milk.

Now answer the following questions

a) What is the meal frequency adopted by Mr. A?

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b) List the various meals Mr. A has had in a day.

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c) Can you suggest a menu for dinner for Mr. A?

Unit 1 RECOMMENDED DIETARY ALLOWANCE AND MEAL PLANNING.indd 14 1/19/2020 2:51:11 PM